

SPEAKING A2 – TOPIC 10: *COMMUNICATION APP*

PART 1: INTERVIEW

1. What's your name? Can I see your ID?
2. Where are you from?
3. Do you prefer texting or calling your friends? Why?
4. Do you like chatting online or talking face to face?
5. What's the first app you open in the morning?

PART 2: LONG TURN

Describe your favorite communication app

You should say:

- *What the app is called*
- *How you use the app to communicate*
- *What features of the app you like the most*

and explain why this app is your favorite for communication

You will have to talk about the topic for 2 to 3 minutes. You have one minute to think about what you're going to say. You can make some notes to help you if you wish.

PART 3: TWO-WAY DISCUSSION

1. How did people keep contact fifty years ago?
2. Do you think people depend too much on communication apps nowadays?
3. What do you think is the best way to communicate when you are working or studying?
4. What kind of communication app do you think will be popular in the future?

SUGGESTIONS

PART 1: INTERVIEW

⇒ *Suggested answers:*

3. Do you prefer texting or calling your friends? Why?

- *I prefer texting because it's more convenient. I can reply anytime, even when I'm busy.*
- *I prefer calling because it feels more real. I can hear my friends' voices and it's easier to express my feelings.*

4. Do you like chatting online or talking face to face?

- *I like talking face to face. It's more natural and I can see people's expressions and emotions.*
- *I like chatting online because it's quick and easy. I can talk to my friends anytime, even if they live far away.*

5. What's the first app you open in the morning?

- *The first app I open is Messenger. I usually check messages from my friends or my study groups before breakfast.*
- *Actually, I don't usually use my phone or any apps in the morning. But if I use one, it's usually a news app to see what's happening in the world.*

PART 2: LONG TURN

1. Selection

This topic can be tricky if you choose a rare or complicated app. An easy option is to talk about a common app you use every day, such as Zalo, Messenger, or WhatsApp.

2. Grammar Point

Use mostly present tenses.

3. Uncommon Vocabulary

Nouns	Meaning	Example
interface	giao diện	<i>The app has a very simple interface, so it's easy to use.</i>
user-friendly design	thiết kế thân thiện với người dùng	<i>Its user-friendly design makes it popular among students.</i>
notification	thông báo	<i>I get message notifications every time my friends text me.</i>
voice message	tin nhắn thoại	<i>I often send voice messages when I'm too busy to type.</i>
video call	cuộc gọi video	<i>I often make video calls to see my family's faces.</i>

Nouns	Meaning	Example
group chat	nhóm trò chuyện	<i>My classmates and I created a group chat for school projects.</i>
privacy setting	cài đặt quyền riêng tư	<i>I always check the privacy settings to keep my information safe.</i>
emoji / sticker	biểu tượng cảm xúc / nhãn dán	<i>Emojis and stickers make my chats more expressive.</i>
internet connection	kết nối Internet	<i>The app only works well with a strong internet connection.</i>

Verbs	Meaning	Example
sign up (for)	đăng ký	<i>I signed up for the app when I started university.</i>
log in / log out	đăng nhập / đăng xuất	<i>I usually log in every morning to check messages.</i>
catch up with sb	bắt kịp tin tức của ai	<i>I use Messenger to catch up with my old friends abroad.</i>
keep in touch with sb	giữ liên lạc với ai đó	<i>The app helps me keep in touch with my relatives.</i>
back up	sao lưu dữ liệu	<i>I always back up my chats before changing my phone.</i>
turn on / off notifications	bật / tắt thông báo	<i>I sometimes turn off notifications when I'm studying.</i>
rely on	phụ thuộc vào	<i>I really rely on this app for both work and study.</i>

Adjectives	Meaning	Example
convenient	tiện lợi	<i>It's very convenient because I can send messages anytime.</i>
secure	an toàn, bảo mật	<i>The app is secure, so I don't worry about my data.</i>
reliable	đáng tin cậy	<i>It's the most reliable app for international calls.</i>
addictive	gây nghiện	<i>Some people find chatting apps quite addictive.</i>
interactive	có tính tương tác	<i>I love how interactive it is with reactions and stickers.</i>
fast-loading	tải nhanh	<i>I like this app because it's fast-loading even on old phones.</i>
customizable	có thể tùy chỉnh	<i>The app is customizable, so I can change themes and colors.</i>
lightweight	nhẹ, không tốn bộ nhớ	<i>It's lightweight, which means it runs smoothly.</i>
engaging	hấp dẫn, thu hút	<i>The design is really engaging for young users.</i>

Adjectives	Meaning	Example
up-to-date	cập nhật, hiện đại	<i>The app stays up-to-date with new features.</i>

Idioms	Meaning	Example
around the clock	suốt ngày đêm	<i>I can text my friends around the clock using this app.</i>
break the ice	phá vỡ sự ngại ngùng	<i>I used stickers to break the ice when chatting with new people.</i>
stay connected	giữ kết nối	<i>It helps me stay connected with my family abroad.</i>
in real time	theo thời gian thực	<i>We can see each other in real time through video calls.</i>
keep sb posted	cập nhật cho ai tin tức mới	<i>My friend always keeps me posted through the app.</i>
hit me up	nhắn cho tôi (thân mật)	<i>You can hit me up on Messenger anytime.</i>
a double-edged sword	con dao hai lưỡi	<i>Communication apps are a double-edged sword — useful but distracting.</i>

PART 3: TWO-WAY DISCUSSION

⇒ *Suggested answers*

1. How did people keep contact fifty years ago?

(Answer) *I think fifty years ago, people kept contact mostly by writing letters or making phone calls.*

(Why) *At that time, there were no smartphones or social media, so people had to wait for days or weeks to get a reply.*

(Example) *For example, my grandparents used to write letters to their friends in other cities, and they were always excited to receive one back.*

(Opposite) *Even though it was slow, many people say it felt more personal and meaningful than texting today.*

2. Do you think people depend too much on communication apps nowadays?

(Answer) *Yes, I think people depend too much on communication apps today.*

(Why) *Many people check their phones all the time and feel uncomfortable if they can't go online, even for a short while.*

(Example) *For example, some students text their friends during class or dinner instead of talking face-to-face.*

(Opposite) *On the other hand, communication apps are very useful for staying in touch with family and friends, especially those who live far away. The key is to use them in balance.*

3. What do you think is the best way to communicate when you are working or studying?

(Answer) *I think the best way to communicate when working or studying is by video call or meeting face-to-face.*

(Why) *This way, people can understand each other better through voice, eye contact, and body language.*

(Example) *For instance, in group projects, a short online meeting can solve problems faster than sending many text messages.*

(Opposite) *Still, texting is also useful for quick updates or reminders, so both ways can be combined depending on the situation.*

4. What kind of communication app do you think will be popular in the future?

(Answer) *I think future communication apps will be more interactive and use new technology like virtual reality or AI.*

(Why) *People always want faster and more realistic ways to connect, so apps may let us talk through 3D images or holograms.*

(Example) *For example, friends might meet in a virtual room and feel like they are sitting together even if they're in different countries.*

(Opposite) *However, even with advanced apps, I believe people will still enjoy simple chatting or video calls because they are easy and familiar.*